This Mexican soup is made with thin *fideo* noodles, which are similar to angel-hair pasta. The avocado and sour cream offset the spiciness of the broth.

sopa seca de fideos

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS PLUS 30 MINS SOAKING **COOK** 15 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

2 dried chipotle chiles
2 large ripe tomatoes, peeled and seeded
2 garlic cloves
1 small onion, coarsely chopped
1 quart (1 liter) chicken stock
3 tbsp vegetable oil
2 skinless boneless chicken breasts, diced
8oz (225g) Mexican *fideo* noodles or dried angel-hair pasta
4 tbsp sour cream, to serve
1 avocado, pit removed, chopped, to serve

1 Soak the dried chiles in water for 30 minutes, then drain, discarding the soaking water. Using a blender, process the tomatoes, garlic, onion, chiles, and 2 tbsp of the stock until smooth. Set aside.

2 Heat 2 tbsp of the oil in a large pan over medium heat and stir-fry the chicken for 2–3 minutes, or until just cooked. Remove from the pan, drain on paper towels, and set aside.

3 Pour the remaining oil into the pan, add the noodles, and cook over low heat, stirring constantly, until the noodles are golden.

4 Pour in the tomato mixture, stir until the noodles are coated, then add the remaining stock and return the chicken to the pan. Cook for 2–3 minutes, or until the noodles are just tender. To serve, ladle into bowls, topping each with sour cream and chopped avocado.